



Where to Base Your Business

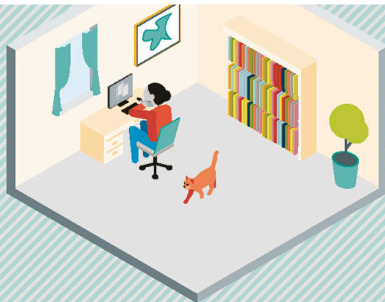
Selecting the right kind of workspace for your business is an important decision. There are a number of options to choose from, with pros and cons to each.

Setting up a workspace

Deciding where you will work from is a key step in the start-up process. Most businesses start life in some part of the home—including a garage or shed—and may stay there, especially since COVID-19 has changed the business landscape, encouraging more flexible working. As things get busier, however, you may want

to establish a clearly defined work environment, such as an office, studio, or workshop. Having a dedicated workspace offers many advantages: it helps free you from outside distractions and interruptions; it can be tailored to your type of work, with sufficient space for equipment; and it can provide, if necessary, a suitable environment for meeting customers or clients. It also

WORKING FROM HOME



Basing yourself at home is an attractive and cost-saving option, but you will need to find a dedicated workspace.

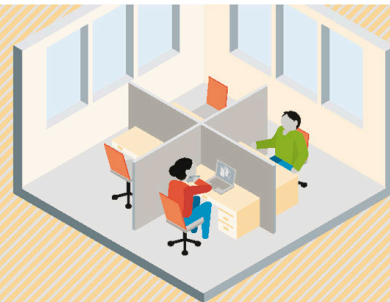
PROS

- **No commute** saves you the time, stress, and cost of traveling.
- **Flexible working hours** enable you to start work early and to work during the evenings if necessary, helping you navigate your other commitments.
- **Lower costs** are possible as you have no rental or parking fees or other transportation costs to pay and refreshments are prepared at home.

CONS

- **Switching off** from work can be more difficult when you can take your laptop into any room and your office space is so easily accessible.
- **Working in isolation** can be stressful and lonely, and other household members may be distracting.
- **A home address** may seem less professional to clients than a separate business address.

SHARED SPACES



A shared space can be an affordable choice, but working alongside others can be a help or a hindrance.

PROS

- **Shared resources**, rented on a flexible basis, offer you affordable office space that you do not need to equip.
- **Working alongside** other businesspeople provides the opportunity to network.
- **Some coworking** spaces provide breakout areas and communal kitchens, which can give sole proprietors a valuable sense of community.

CONS

- **The commute** to the office may take time, cause stress, and cost you gas or fares.
- **Lack of privacy** in an open office space may not be appropriate for some businesses.
- **Working in close** proximity to others can prove a distraction.
- **Higher costs** than home-working, due to rental fees and transportation costs.